



Objectclasses in OpenLDAP

I hope readers have explored the various attributes used to create records in LDAP directories. Once you have a list of the data items (attributes) that you want to store in your directory, the next step is to locate the appropriate objectclasses that contain those attributes. You can use multiple objectclasses in one record, but not all objectclasses can be used together. In this article, we will discuss how to find and use objectclasses to obtain all the attributes needed to store the desired data in a directory.

Let us approach this exercise with a specific example—an address book, or in other words, a directory containing personal information about friends. The information we would normally want to store for each entry would be as follows:

a) Name of the person

- b) Complete address, along with PIN code
- c) Home phone number
- d) Mobile phone number
- e) E-mail address

To create a directory with the above information, we would need to look at attributes that provide the above. Based on the attributes, we will determine the objectclasses to be used.